

GOOGLE ADS COMPLETE GUIDE

Plan, launch and improve your first campaign with a clear conversion goal and a controlled budget.

SEARCH / MEASUREMENT / OPTIMIZATION

India-first examples • Worksheets • 30-day plan

ORIENTATION

Contents & how to use

Read pages 3-15 before spending. Use the worksheets during setup. The 30-day plan turns each decision into a task.

PART	WHAT YOU WILL LEAVE WITH
01 Choose your route / 03-05	A campaign goal, business model, and sensible measurement plan
02 Build the foundation / 06-15	Account, landing page, conversion action, keywords and ads
03 Launch carefully / 16-20	A complete preflight checklist and a controlled first run
04 Improve with evidence / 21-27	A worked example, worksheets, a 30-day plan and references

The operating principle

An ad click is a cost. A useful conversion is an outcome. Design the path backward from the outcome: valuable action → landing page → ad promise → search intent → targeting and bid.

REALITY CHECK

No campaign, bid strategy or suggested budget guarantees leads or sales. Your costs depend on auction competition, relevance, conversion quality and your market. The rupee figures in this book are illustrative planning examples, not Google prices or benchmarks.

01 / THE MAP

What Google Ads actually does

A campaign chooses where to advertise and how to pursue a goal; ad groups organize related messages; ads and assets carry the offer.

IF YOU NEED...	START HERE	WHY
People actively searching for a service	Search campaign	You can map search intent to a focused service page.
Sales from a product catalog	Merchant Center + Shopping or Performance Max	Your product data, feed quality and purchase tracking become central.
Broad reach or video discovery	Video / Demand Gen / Display	Useful when you have creative assets and a different discovery goal.
App installs or actions	App campaign	Uses app-specific measurement and inventory.

Beginner decision rule

If someone can describe your offer in a search phrase and you have a page that answers it, build one Search campaign first. This is an editorial recommendation, not a platform requirement. Google also offers other campaign types; availability and setup can change. [1]

ONE PATH THROUGH THE BOOK

The running Illustrative Example is a Surat-based solar consultation service. It sells a consultation, so a qualified enquiry matters more than a page visit. Replace it with your own offer when using the worksheets.

01 / STRATEGY

Choose one outcome

Name the business result before selecting a campaign objective in the interface.

BUSINESS	PRIMARY RESULT TO MEASURE	SECONDARY SIGNAL
Local service	Qualified form submission or relevant call	Contact-page view
Ecommerce	Completed purchase with accurate value	Add to cart
Course / digital product	Successful checkout	Checkout start
B2B service	Qualified enquiry or booked consultation	Brochure download

Write an offer people can act on

- Audience: Who has the problem? Example: Surat homeowners considering rooftop solar.
- Specific promise: What does the page help them decide? Example: request a site assessment and estimate.
- Proof: Show genuine credentials, process, location and terms; never invent reviews, savings or certifications.
- Action: One clear next step. Example: submit a short request and expect a response during stated business hours.

WORKSHEET

Complete this line before launch: "We help [audience] with [specific need] in [service area]. A valuable action is [event]. We can verify it through [method]."

01 / ECONOMICS

Set a budget you can control

A daily budget is an average, not a strict daily cap. For most campaigns, Google states the daily spending limit can be 2× the average daily budget and the monthly limit is 30.4× it. Exceptions apply. [2]

ILLUSTRATIVE INPUT	EXAMPLE	WHAT IT TELLS YOU
Average daily budget	₹500	Most-campaign monthly limit: $500 \times 30.4 = ₹15,200$.
Expected lead value	Unknown initially	Ask sales what fraction of enquiries are qualified and what a sale is worth.
Maximum viable lead cost	Set from your own margin	Do not borrow an internet “good CPL” benchmark.

A simple break-even lens

Illustrative Example: if a completed sale contributes ₹4,000 after service costs and 1 in 10 qualified leads becomes a sale, the rough break-even cost per qualified lead is ₹400. This is a hypothetical calculation, not a predicted close rate. Account for overhead, refunds, taxes and the quality of attribution before making a decision.

SAFETY RULE

Set a budget you can afford to lose while testing. Review the Budget report and billing settings. A ₹500 average daily budget can produce more than ₹500 of spend on one day under the applicable spending limits. [2]

02 / FOUNDATION

Create an account that you own

Use the business owner's Google account and payments profile. Grant a freelancer or agency access instead of sharing passwords.

01 Account and billing

Confirm legal business name, country, currency, time zone, payment settings and billing access before launch. Check the current Google Ads billing help for available payment methods in your account.

02 Business readiness

Publish a real landing page with working mobile navigation, accurate contact details, transparent offer terms and a privacy notice appropriate to your data collection.

03 Ownership and permissions

Keep domain, analytics, conversion tags, product feed and business profile under durable business ownership. Document who can edit, bill and approve ads.

04 Verification

Check account notifications for advertiser verification tasks and submit authentic documents if requested. Requirements vary by advertiser and country. [3]

INDIA NOTE

For GST, invoicing, TDS and input tax credit, use the current Google billing guidance and your accountant. Treatment depends on account, entity and transaction; this book does not assert a universal tax rate. [4]

02 / MEASUREMENT

Track the real action

A campaign can optimize for the wrong thing if a page view or generic button click is marked as its main conversion.

01 Define the action

Choose purchase, confirmed enquiry or a meaningful call. For lead quality, decide how your team will flag spam, duplicates and sales-ready enquiries.

02 Create a conversion action

In Google Ads, create a website or call conversion action that matches the event; install the Google tag or connect a supported measurement setup. [5]

03 Choose Primary or Secondary

Primary actions typically feed the main Conversions reporting and bidding; use Secondary to observe softer events. Review campaign-specific goals so an unintended action is not optimized. [6]

04 Test the complete flow

Use a test form or purchase in a safe test environment; check the thank-you event fires once, on the correct page or event, then inspect status in Google Ads/Tag Assistant. [5]

BAD SIGNAL	BETTER SIGNAL
Every homepage view	A successfully submitted lead form
Every “WhatsApp” button tap	Verified conversation or qualified downstream lead where measurement permits
Checkout page visit	Completed purchase with accurate order value

02 / ARCHITECTURE

Build a small Search campaign

Google's Search setup includes goal, campaign settings, keywords, ads, budget and review. Wording and layout in the interface may shift. [1]

LEVEL	EXAMPLE FOR SURAT SOLAR	RULE
Campaign	Surat Solar enquiries Search	One location/goal/budget decision.
Ad group 1	Residential solar consultation	Closely related queries and page.
Ad group 2	Industrial solar consultation	Separate intent, ad copy and page.
Ad / assets	Relevant headlines, descriptions, sitelinks	Only claims supported by the destination.

The clean-room rule

Keep unlike offers apart when they need different landing pages or sales handling. Avoid one enormous ad group that mixes “solar repair”, “industrial installation” and “free solar scheme”. You can add structure after real search terms reveal demand.

WORKSHEET

Campaign name: _____ | Primary conversion: _____ | Service area: _____

Ad group 1 intent: _____ | Destination URL: _____

Ad group 2 intent: _____ | Destination URL: _____

02 / DISCOVERY

Find purchase-ready searches

Keyword Planner helps find keyword ideas and forecasts. A keyword is your targeting input; the search term is what the person actually typed. [7, 8]

01 Seed from the offer

Write customer phrases, not internal jargon: “solar panel installation surat”, “rooftop solar quote surat”.

02 Classify intent

High: quote, price, service, near me. Mixed: subsidy, calculator. Research: what is solar energy. These classifications are editorial examples, not Google categories.

03 Group around a page

Place one coherent set of phrases with an ad and landing page that answer the same request.

04 Check reality

Use Keyword Planner and live searches to examine relevance, search volume estimates and competing offers. Forecasts are estimates, not actual costs.

MATCH TYPE	EXAMPLE INPUT	USEFUL CAUTION
Broad	solar installation surat	May reach related searches; review terms and tracking carefully.
Phrase	“solar installation surat”	Meaning of the phrase can match, including close variations.
Exact	[solar installation surat]	Same meaning or intent may match; not literal text only.

02 / RELEVANCE

Build negative keyword guardrails

Negative keywords exclude unwanted searches, but their matching behavior differs from positive keyword match types. Review the search terms report instead of assuming every variant is blocked. [7, 8]

SEARCH TERM	DECISION	WHY
solar installation jobs surat	Exclude “jobs” if not hiring	Job seeker, different outcome.
solar panel repair surat	Exclude “repair” if you do not repair	Service mismatch.
rooftop solar quote surat	Keep / consider exact ad group	Matches quotation offer.
government solar subsidy	Review before excluding	Could be useful or irrelevant depending on offer and page.

A weekly review loop

01 Export terms

Open the search terms report and sort by spend, clicks and conversions. Not every query is necessarily shown. [8]

02 Label intent

Mark relevant, uncertain and irrelevant. Read the term in context before excluding.

03 Act narrowly

Add a suitable negative or move strong terms into a tighter group. Avoid excluding words that also appear in valuable searches.

COPY-PASTE STARTER LIST

Consider only if irrelevant to your offer: jobs, career, salary, course, training, DIY, repair, used. There is no universal negative list; inspect each term first.

02 / TARGETING

Location means more than a pin

Google’s default location option can include people in, regularly in, or showing interest in your targeted area. If physical presence matters, review the “Presence” option. Location targeting is based on signals and is not a perfect boundary. [9]

BUSINESS SITUATION	PRACTICAL SETTING TO REVIEW
Service only in Surat	Target Surat/serviceable radius; review Presence and exclude unserved areas.
Pan-India digital download	Target locations where checkout, support and language make sense.
Tourist booking a Surat service from elsewhere	Broader Presence or interest may matter; test with source locations.

Other filters

Choose languages based on the audience and actual ad/landing-page language. Set ad schedule only if it reflects when you can serve or measure demand. Google location options and campaign interfaces can vary. [9]

VERIFICATION

After launch, inspect geographic performance and lead records. If enquiries originate outside the area, compare location setting, search intent, contact form city field and CRM data before changing multiple controls.

02 / DELIVERY

Bid for the goal you can measure

Google offers bid strategies for clicks, impressions, conversions and value; Smart Bidding uses auction signals. Your setup should follow the quality of your conversion data. [10]

SITUATION	WORKING CHOICE	REVIEW
Tracking incomplete	Fix measurement before scaling	A click-focused test may gather traffic, but not prove lead quality.
Reliable lead conversion	Consider Maximize conversions	Check goal selection, lead quality, budget and actual cost/lead.
Accurate purchase values	Consider Maximize conversion value	Confirm transaction values and returns/refunds handling.
Target CPA or ROAS	Use after setting a defensible target	Overly restrictive targets can limit traffic; inspect results over time.

Do not judge from one day

Conversion delay, weekly demand and limited volume make early readings noisy. Record what changed and when. Avoid simultaneous changes to budget, keywords, ads, landing page and goals; otherwise the cause becomes unclear.

DECISION PROMPT

Ask: “Are we measuring the action that creates value?” before asking: “Which bid strategy is best?” [6, 10]

02 / CREATIVE

Write ads that answer the search

Responsive search ads accept multiple headlines and descriptions; Google combines them for relevant searches. Include accurate variations, not the same phrase repeated. [11]

JOB	ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE
Reflect intent	Residential Solar Consultation in Surat
Explain the offer	Request a Site Assessment
Give real proof	Local Installation Team - only if verifiably true
Set next step	Get a Written Estimate

A copy formula

Search need + specific offer + authentic proof + clear next step. Description example: “Planning rooftop solar for your home in Surat? Share your roof and electricity details to request a site assessment.” This is illustrative copy, not a claim that the business exists.

- ☐ The ad and landing page describe the same service, area and offer.
- ☐ All prices, deadlines, subsidy statements and credentials are verified and current.
- ☐ The next step is visible on a phone without hunting through the page.
- ☐ Final URL loads, works on mobile and respects Google destination requirements. [12]

02 / CREATIVE

Add helpful assets

Sitelinks, callouts, structured snippets, images, calls or location assets can add useful context when available and eligible. Use only real destinations and details.

ASSET	ILLUSTRATIVE USE	CHECK
Sitelink	Residential Solar / Industrial Solar / FAQs	Each link resolves to a matching page.
Call	Business phone number	Calls are answered; track quality where possible.
Location	Verified business location	Link the correct Business Profile if applicable.
Callout	Site Assessment Available	The offer really exists and is explained.

Make the phone experience the priority

Read every ad and destination on a small screen. Verify tap-to-call and forms. Test the message after submission, including what a real user sees when something goes wrong.

USE OF AI

If you draft copy or images with AI tools, verify all claims, likenesses, licences and the landing-page match. Google’s advertising policies still apply to generated content. [12]

02 / DESTINATION

The page earns the conversion

The landing page needs to resolve the exact promise in the ad. A faster or prettier page cannot rescue a confusing offer.

01 First screen

State what you offer, where it is available and the primary action in plain language.

02 Proof and explanation

Show the process, real examples or authentic credentials. Explain price, qualification or consultation conditions when relevant.

03 Form design

Collect only information sales needs to respond. Show privacy handling and do not request sensitive data without a reason and proper safeguards.

04 Thank-you state

Confirm success, state when to expect contact and fire the conversion event once.

05 Mobile QA

Try the complete path on your own phone with a slow connection. Check layout, legibility, links and error messages.

POLICY CHECK

Google's destination policies cover function, usefulness and accessibility; misrepresentation rules require clear and honest business and product information. Review both before launch.
[12]

03 / LAUNCH

The 15-minute preflight

Use this immediately before publishing. A single wrong conversion action or location option can distort your first month of learning.

- ☐ One primary business goal is selected; secondary events do not silently drive bidding.
- ☐ Conversion test completed and the event triggers once.
- ☐ Campaign location and location option reflect where customers can be served.
- ☐ Networks, language, schedule and campaign type match the plan.
- ☐ Daily average budget and possible overdelivery are understood.
- ☐ Keyword match types and starter negatives were reviewed.
- ☐ Ad text, offer, URL and mobile landing page agree.
- ☐ Billing, verification notices and ad policy status were checked.
- ☐ Sales owner knows how to answer and label new enquiries.
- ☐ Change log and review date are ready.

FIRST 48 HOURS

Look for disapprovals, broken URLs, absent conversion signals, unexpectedly irrelevant queries and spend outside your service area. Do not interpret a few clicks as proof of a winning or losing campaign.

03 / DIAGNOSIS

Read the funnel from left to right

Do not make a bid change before finding the stage where the result breaks.

OBSERVATION	CHECK FIRST	POSSIBLE ACTION
Few impressions	Eligibility, location, search demand, status	Resolve review/targeting; broaden only with intent.
Clicks, wrong audience	Search terms and geographic report	Refine relevance, exclusions, ad promise.
Relevant clicks, no leads	Mobile page, form, offer, tracking	Test the whole path; compare user recordings if lawful.
Many leads, few qualified	Query intent, lead form and sales labels	Tighten message and qualify on page.
Conversions but poor economics	Margin, lead quality and attribution	Change offer, page or bidding with a documented hypothesis.

Use more than one metric

CTR describes how often an impression gets a click; CPC is spend divided by clicks; conversion rate is recorded conversions divided by eligible interactions under the report definition; cost per conversion is spend divided by recorded conversions. These figures alone do not prove profitability.

REALITY CHECK

Platform-attributed conversions are a measurement view. Verify actual enquiries, invoices or orders in your business records and account for delayed or duplicate sales.

03 / IMPROVEMENT

A disciplined weekly optimization loop

One useful review is better than daily changes driven by noise.

01 Reconcile

Compare spend, conversions and actual leads/orders for the same date range. Record attribution or timing gaps.

02 Clean traffic

Review search terms, location and devices for mismatches. Add negatives only with a written reason.

03 Inspect lead quality

Tag spam, duplicate, out-of-area, qualified and sale. Ask sales why promising enquiries failed.

04 Choose one hypothesis

Example: "Repair searches are diluting consultations; excluding repair should improve qualified lead share."

05 Change and log

Record date, settings, expected effect and the metric that will decide whether to keep the change.

WEEKLY LOG	ENTRY
Period + spend	_____
Conversions / qualified leads / sales	_____ / _____ / _____
Top irrelevant themes	_____
One change + reason	_____
Review date + decision	_____

03 / BRANCH

If you sell products online

Ecommerce needs accurate purchase value and reliable product data. Google Merchant Center supplies product information for Shopping and retail Performance Max. [13]

01 Catalogue

Create the Merchant Center account, verify the website and submit accurate product titles, prices, availability, shipping and images.

02 Checkout

Test payment, taxes, delivery information, return policy and mobile checkout as an actual customer would.

03 Purchase tracking

Pass the right order value and transaction identifier; guard against duplicate purchase events.

04 Campaign choice

Compare Shopping and Performance Max using your needs, feed readiness and reporting. Performance Max can serve across multiple Google channels. [13]

05 Product review

Inspect disapprovals, feed errors, product-level results and returns, not just a blended ROAS.

ILLUSTRATIVE CALCULATION

If an order is ₹2,000 and contribution after product, delivery and payment costs is ₹500, ₹500 is an initial upper bound on acquisition cost before fixed overhead and returns. This is arithmetic, not a recommended target.

03 / TRUST

Policy and India practicalities

Treat policy checks as part of product quality, not a last-minute hurdle.

CHECK	PRACTICAL ACTION
Identity	Match ad, domain, company name and verification documents.
Claims	Substantiate prices, offers, certification, savings and finance claims.
Destination	Keep the page functional, mobile usable and clear about the business.
Customer data	Use a privacy notice; collect and retain only what the process needs.
Billing / tax	Review current invoices and payment profile; seek qualified tax advice.

Important boundaries

Google may require advertiser verification and may limit ads that fail policy. Financial, medical, political and other regulated categories can need additional checks. This guide gives general education; use current Google policy pages and local professional advice for regulated claims or tax questions. [3, 4, 12]

BEFORE A FREELANCER LAUNCHES

Get client approval for the exact copy, destination and budget. Keep the account in the client's ownership, with appropriate access, and agree how leads and reporting will be handed over.

04 / WORKED EXAMPLE

From search to qualified enquiry

The following scenario is illustrative. No business results or platform forecasts are being claimed.

DECISION	ILLUSTRATIVE SETUP
Offer	Surat residential rooftop solar consultation
Primary outcome	Valid form submission requesting an assessment
Campaign	Search; Surat service area; review Presence option
Ad group	Residential solar consultation
Keywords	“rooftop solar installation surat”; [solar installation surat]
Negatives	jobs and repair, only if those requests cannot be served
Ad promise	Request a site assessment and written estimate
Page	Residential offer, process, real proof, short form, contact details
Follow-up	Sales labels valid, out-of-area, duplicate, qualified and won

The feedback loop

After launch, a “solar repair” query appears with spend and no fit. Confirm the company does not offer repair, add a narrow negative, then check subsequent terms and lead quality. If enquiries are relevant but cannot afford the service, improve the page’s qualification and sales explanation before expanding traffic.

04 / WORKSHEETS

Your one-page campaign brief

Fill this page before opening the campaign builder. Keep a copy alongside your change log.

PROMPT	WRITE YOUR ANSWER
Offer and service area	_____
Who is ready to buy?	_____
Primary event and test method	_____
Qualified lead / order definition	_____
Landing URL and mobile QA owner	_____
Initial keyword themes	_____
Queries that must be excluded	_____
Budget and monthly exposure	_____
Billing / policy approval owner	_____
Review date and success criterion	_____

DECISION STATEMENT

"I will continue, change or pause the campaign after reviewing [qualified outcomes] alongside [spend] and [sales evidence] over [review window]." Set your own review window based on volume and conversion delay.

04 / ACTION PLAN

30 days / Build

The timing below is a working sequence, not a promise that an account will receive traffic or conversions by a particular day.

DAY	ACTION	DELIVERABLE
01	Choose one offer and business outcome	One-sentence campaign brief
02	Define qualified lead / completed sale	Written acceptance criteria
03	Confirm domain, ownership and access	Account access map
04	Check billing and verification status	Issue list / approvals
05	Audit competitor search results honestly	Offer and message notes
06	Sketch a matching mobile landing page	Page outline
07	Publish and test the page	Working live destination
08	Choose primary and secondary events	Measurement plan
09	Install tag or connect tracking	Tag status checked
10	Submit a safe test conversion	Evidence it fires once
11	Research seed phrases in Keyword Planner	Intent shortlist
12	Group related search themes	Ad group map
13	Write truthful headlines and descriptions	Ad copy draft
14	Add relevant assets and negatives	Launch draft
15	Run the preflight and publish	Signed-off change log

04 / ACTION PLAN

30 days / Learn

If conversion volume is too low for conclusions, extend the observation window rather than manufacturing certainty.

DAY	ACTION	DELIVERABLE
16	Check status, disapprovals, URLs and budget	Launch health note
17	Test a real enquiry path on mobile	End-to-end QA
18	Check first search terms for obvious mismatch	Term notes
19	Reconcile recorded leads with actual leads	Measurement gap list
20	Ask sales to label lead quality	Qualified lead count
21	Review locations and serviceability	Geo finding
22	Fix the clearest page or form friction	One documented change
23	Review ad promise against queries	Copy hypothesis
24	Add narrowly justified negatives	Traffic refinement
25	Check lead response time and handoff	Sales process fix
26	Compare spend with viable economics	Cost and margin note
27	Review product feed if applicable	Feed issue list
28	Choose one controlled experiment	Test plan
29	Prepare stakeholder report	Facts, uncertainties, next step
30	Keep, change or pause based on evidence	Next 30-day brief

REFERENCE

The short glossary

Keep this page open while reading campaign reports.

TERM	PLAIN ENGLISH
Impression	An ad was shown.
Click / CPC	A click / spend divided by clicks.
CTR	Clicks divided by impressions.
Conversion	A recorded action you configured as valuable.
Conversion rate	Recorded conversions relative to interactions in the selected report.
CPA / CPL	Spend divided by tracked acquisitions or leads.
ROAS	Attributed conversion value divided by ad spend; not profit.
Keyword / search term	Targeting input / the user query that triggered a match.
Negative keyword	An exclusion for unwanted matching.
Primary conversion	An action generally included for main conversion reporting and bidding.
Attribution	The rules used to assign credit for a conversion.
Learning / delay	Automated strategies and reporting may need time and data after changes.

A USEFUL REPORTING LINE

Spend ₹____ → tracked conversions ____ → verified qualified outcomes ____ → actual sales ____
. If one of these is unknown, say so explicitly.

SOURCES

Official sources & further reading

Google Ads and policy pages below were reviewed for this September 2026 edition. Interface text and requirements may change; open the current article before acting.

[1] Create a Search campaign

support.google.com/google-ads/answer/9510373

[8] About the search terms report

support.google.com/google-ads/answer/2472708

[2] About spending limits

support.google.com/google-ads/answer/10486637

[9] Prevent clicks outside geo locations

support.google.com/google-ads/answer/9376662

[3] Advertiser verification tasks

support.google.com/adspolicy/answer/15577076

[10] Determine a bid strategy

support.google.com/google-ads/answer/2472725

[4] Taxes in your country

support.google.com/google-ads/answer/2375370

[11] About responsive search ads

support.google.com/google-ads/answer/7684791

[5] Set up your web conversions

support.google.com/google-ads/answer/16560108

[12] Destination requirements

support.google.com/adspolicy/answer/6368661

[6] Primary and secondary conversion actions

support.google.com/google-ads/answer/11461796

[12] Misrepresentation

support.google.com/adspolicy/answer/6020955

[7] Keyword matching options

support.google.com/google-ads/answer/7478529

[13] About product data

support.google.com/google-ads/answer/2382952

[7] Keyword Planner

support.google.com/google-ads/answer/7337243

[13] PMax channel performance

support.google.com/google-ads/answer/16260130

NOW BUILD ONE CAMPAIGN YOU CAN EXPLAIN.

Start with one real offer. Measure one valuable action. Improve from the search terms and the quality of actual outcomes. Keep a record of every change.

YOUR NEXT THREE MOVES

- 01 Complete the campaign brief
- 02 Test conversion measurement

- 03 Run the launch checklist